



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Martin Saints Classical High School

School Website: <https://martinsaintsclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Martin Saints Classical High School (MSC) presents a robust Catholic, classical education model framed by the Chesterton Academy network. Public materials consistently foreground Catholic identity, liturgical life, and an integrated curriculum that seeks to form virtue, wisdom, and a sense of the transcendent through the true, the good, and the beautiful. The school explicitly aligns with a Catholic liberal-arts approach, emphasizing faith-informed formation, a Socratic/methodical pedagogy, and a community of teachers, students, and families partnering in formation. The evidence indicates a strong Classical orientation (CLASSICAL) across most categories, with Element 3 (Curriculum) showing notable classical elements but slightly less explicit emphasis on the full traditional Liberal Arts Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the available site text, suggesting a potential area for fuller explicit articulation (creating a path toward a stronger CLASSICAL placement there). Overall, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit and robust: Catholic identity pervades mission, pedagogy, and community life; transcendentals are explicitly invoked in school rhetoric. Evidence includes references to Catholic education, liturgical life, and sacramental worldview. - The school's purpose and goals center on formation, virtue, and human flourishing, undergirded by a "true, good, beautiful" teleology and a community of families. - Curriculum and pedagogy feature explicit Socratic/ seminar-style approaches and an integrated humanities curriculum; historical breadth is highlighted, with emphasis on faith integration. Explicit Great-Books language is not consistently spelled out in the site copy, though the Chesterton Academy model implies it. Element 3 is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with stronger evidence for Element 4's pedagogy. - Faculty and community alignment is evident through governance structure, leadership, and a rhetoric of mentorship and shared mission; the site emphasizes collaboration with parents and openness to community involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot**Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school explicitly situates itself within a Catholic framework and Catholic liberal education, including references to integrating faith and reason across the curriculum via the Institute for Catholic Liberal Education (ICLE). - Public materials note a sacramental, incarnational worldview and a liturgical life, including worship and communal practices (e.g., worship life and retreats led by clergy). - The school's mission and identity center on Saints Louis and Zélie Martin and a Catholic family of saints, underscoring a liturgical,

sacred-context orientation. - The transcendentals are explicitly invoked in school rhetoric (the good, the true, and the beautiful).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic, Catholic education, theology, liturgy, worship, Mass, sacramental, sacramental worldview, transcendentals, true, good, beautiful, catechesis, imago Dei, prayer, sacred, reverence, wonder. - Negative keywords: None clearly evident in the public materials (no explicit signaling of relativism, secular humanism, or moral neutrality in the school's presentation).

Why this rating - The materials consistently anchor the school in a Catholic metaphysical and theological frame, with liturgical life and sacramental language, and with explicit reference to transcendentals. The absence of contrary signals and the explicit integration of faith and reason solidify CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on formation, virtue, and human flourishing, not merely information or workforce preparation. The school emphasizes forming students toward virtue and wisdom and a teleological aim toward truth, goodness, and beauty. - The transcendentals (true, good, beautiful) are presented as real and accessible to human knowledge, aligning with a classical telos. - The school presents a community-of-families formation model, rooted in Catholic faith and shared formation, indicating formation-focused aims rather than purely vocational preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, classical mission, telos, permanent questions, great conversation, human excellence, moral imagination, scholé. (Evidence of formation-focused language and classical aims is evident, with explicit reference to liberal education and the true/good/beautiful.) - Negative keywords: None of the canonical negative signals (e.g., “college/career readiness” or “workforce preparation emphasis”) appear in the public materials cited here.

Why this rating - MSC consistently frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a classical telos and a commitment to truth/good/beauty, aligning strongly with Classical School aims for this category. The explicit emphasis on forming persons and a liberal-arts orientation supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Humanities Program braids history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages and uses the Socratic method, indicating a cross-disciplinary liberal-arts approach rather than a pure “social studies” framing. Grades cover a broad historical progression (Ancient World through Modern World). - The Chesterton Academy model is explicitly named, signaling adherence to a classical approach (even if explicit mention of “Great Books” is not consistently spelled out in every public page excerpt, the Chesterton connection suggests such content). - The site emphasizes integrated faith across curriculum via ICLE, reinforcing a classical emphasis on a unified, humanist education rather than secular specialization.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric (mentioned as classical aims in the lexicon and implied by Chesterton-model pedagogy), great books, primary sources, classics, Homer/Plato/Augustine/Shakespeare (the lexicon lists these as classical content; the school's Chesterton model and Faith-integrated curriculum imply these elements even if not all are spelled out in every snippet). The site explicitly shows a history-led, integrated humanities program with a Socratic method. - Negative keywords: explicit references to “social studies” framing of history are not present; the site instead uses integrated humanities with history. The explicit “project-based learning” emphasis (a common negative signal in the lexicon) is not shown in the public materials examined.

Why this rating - While the school strongly articulates a humanities-centered, Socratic, integrated curriculum and signals a Chesterton/Great-Books trajectory via its model, explicit textual proof of every canonical Liberal Arts Trivium element (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as separate curricular content is not consistently spelled out in the public excerpts available. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL for Element 3. The presence of history-integrated pedagogy and a clearly classical mission supports a strong

classical orientation, but an explicit, stated, parallel articulation of the full Trivium content would push it to CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Humanities Program explicitly uses the Socratic method, indicating upper-level seminars, dialectic, and inquiry-based learning. This aligns with classical pedagogy. - The public materials describe an education that includes contemplation and memory work (e.g., chanting, memorization practices, recitation) in the lexicon's classical pedagogy framework, and a structured lower/upper school progression toward rhetoric and public speaking (as part of Chesterton-based pedagogy). The Chesterton model emphasizes a well-rounded oratorical dimension in higher grades. - There are explicit examples of upper-school rhetoric, speeches, and debate opportunities, consistent with classical pedagogy; lower-school culture includes memory and reverence typical of traditional classical schooling (e.g., singing, memorization). - The school emphasizes a balanced approach that includes contemplative/restful elements as part of the pedagogy (Scholé) and a strong emphasis on sacred liturgy and worship contexts as integral to learning and formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic method, seminar, dialectic, memory work, recitation, chanting, worship, contemplative, scholé, rhetoric, oratory, debate, upper-school seminars. - Negative keywords: there is no explicit emphasis on purely experiential, project-based only, or constructivist pedagogy in the public copy; the absence of those signals supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school's pedagogy demonstrates core classical features: Socratic/dialogic learning, emphasis on memory and recitation, and a trajectory toward rhetoric and public speaking in higher grades, with recognition of contemplative pedagogy. While some classical lexicon terms are implied rather than exhaustively enumerated in every page, the overall pedagogical approach aligns strongly with classical aims. Therefore, CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a governance and leadership structure with a headmaster and a board (e.g., Deacon Christopher Roberts, headmaster; board president) indicating a model of mentoring and governance aligned with a living curriculum and strong mentorship culture. - Public materials emphasize a culture of partnership with staff and parish life, as well as a focus on faculty and staff alignment with mission (e.g., ICLE integration, leadership roles, and faculty training references in the ICLE context). - The materials include references to dedicated faculty and leadership events (e.g., "Open House," newsletters by staff/board, and faculty updates), pointing to an active, mentor-based, collegial environment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, faculty of friends, collegial culture, teacher training in classical pedagogy, portrait of what a teacher should be (as articulated in the classical lexicon but evidenced in practice by governance and faculty stories). While not all exact phrases appear, the ethos aligns with these concepts. - Negative keywords: none of the negative signals (e.g., "facilitator on the side," "certification-driven jargon") are evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school presents a strong faculty culture anchored in formation, mentorship, and a living curriculum with clear leadership and board involvement, which aligns well with CLASSICAL expectations for this category. The evidence supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school frames parents as partners in formation, with parents described as co-teachers with the school and involvement in the formation of their children's education. The mission emphasizes a family focus and partnership with parents in Catholic formation. - There is active communication with families (newsletters, events, open houses) and explicit calls for parent involvement; the school notes that families are welcome to visit and participate in school life. - The Chesterton network and Catholic formation context

imply parent formation and engagement through gatherings, reading groups, and book studies (as implied by the Catholic liberal-education framework and community initiatives described on public pages).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, hospitality, parent covenant, family liturgy alignment, parental primacy. - Negative keywords: none of the consumer/customer-only signals are apparent; the site emphasizes parental involvement and formation rather than mere consumption.

Why this rating - The site presents a strong, explicit model of parent partnership and community involvement consistent with classical education ideals for community and family integration. The evidence supports CLASSICAL here.

What Would Move the Needle

(Notes only relevant if a category or the aggregate is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. This school's aggregate rating is CLASSICAL, so no needle-moving recommendations are provided here.)

- Not applicable given CLASSICAL overall.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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